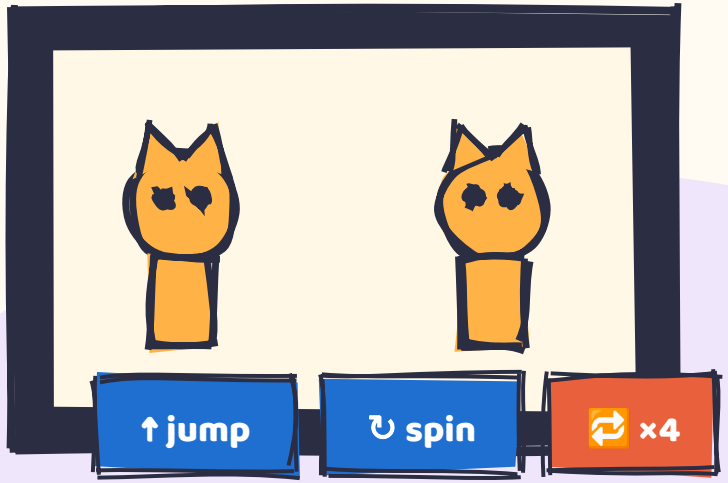
Little Explorers · Class 20

ScratchJr Dance Party

Make your characters dance to music!

Dance steps | Repeat & sound | Two dancers



Did you know?
Big films use computers to make cartoon characters dance. Animators tell every move what to do!

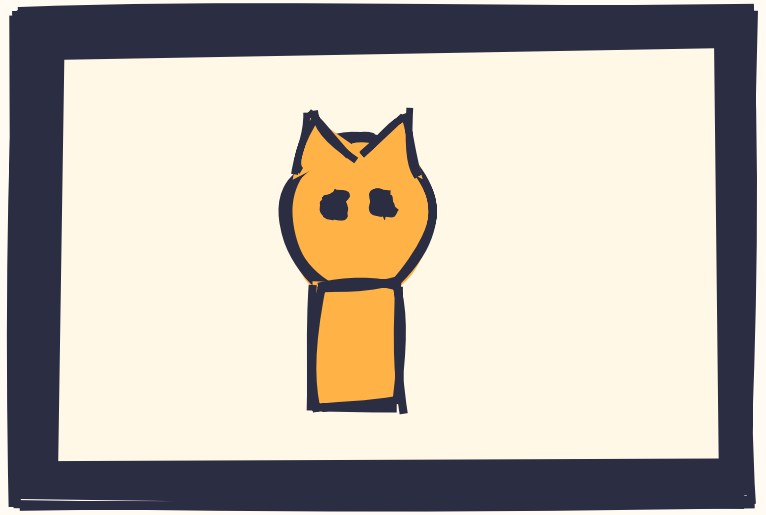
LEARN

Let's wonder...

Can a cartoon learn to dance?

Party time!

A cartoon cat wants to dance at our party, but it doesn't know any moves. We have to teach it: hop, spin, wiggle, repeat! Ready to be dance teachers?



It just knows?

Magic?

We code the moves!

Today: you code a **dance party** in ScratchJr with moves, repeats, music and two dancers.

Learning objectives

Today I can...

1	**Dance steps:** make a character do **dance moves in order**	**Proof:** my character does 3 moves
2	**Repeat & sound:** use a **repeat** block and add **music**	**Proof:** my dance repeats with music
3	**Two dancers:** make **two characters** dance together when I tap the flag	**Proof:** both my dancers start together

LEARN

Objective 1 · Dance steps · video

Video time!



The Robot Dance!

Danny Go! · about 3 minutes · youtu.be/T8Df3VZCKUc

Watch for...

1. Copy every move!
2. Which moves did you **repeat**?
3. Can you remember the moves in **order**?

Scan to watch

After the video: Which dance move was your favourite? Today we teach a computer to dance!

LEARN

Objective 1 · Dance steps

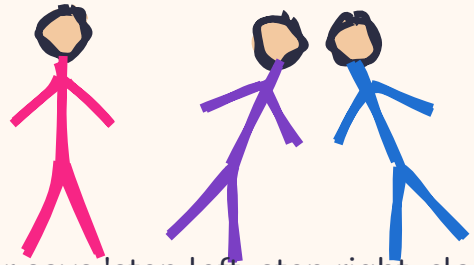
A dance is moves in order

The idea

A dance is a **sequence**: step, step, jump, spin. Each move happens **one after another**.

In ScratchJr, each block is one move. Snap them in a line from left to right.

Example: a dance teacher



A dance teacher says 'step left, step right, clap, turn'. You copy in order. Mix up the order and it's a different dance!

LEARN

Objective 2 · Repeat & sound

Repeat and music

The idea

The **repeat** block (orange) wraps around moves and does them again. Change the number to choose how many times.

Add a **sound** block (green) to play music. Record your own beat by tapping the microphone!

Example: a song chorus



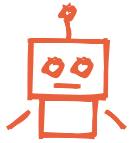
repeat 4

In a song, the chorus comes back again and again. Our dance moves come back again and again with a repeat block.

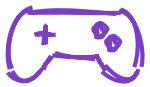
LEARN

Real world

Dancing with technology



Dancing robots
Robots perform dances at shows



Dance games
Games copy your dance moves



Cartoons
Animators code dance moves



Light shows
Lights dance to the beat

? Would you like a robot that dances with you?

Fun fact
Some robot dogs can dance to music!

Part 2 · Make it

Now let's put it to work!

You know the ideas. Time to play, build and test. Use these slides while you work:

1. Freeze dance code
2. Teach the cat to dance
3. Repeat and add music
4. Two dancers
5. Party test
6. Dance challenges

MAKE

Class game

Freeze dance code

How to play

1. Teacher holds up block cards: **JUMP**, **SPIN**, **CLAP**, **WIGGLE**.
2. Children do each move in order when the music plays.
3. Teacher adds a **REPEAT 3** card around them.
4. When the music stops, FREEZE!

Then discuss

What did the repeat card change?

Big idea

A repeat makes a short dance last longer.



MAKE

Objective 1 · Build step 1 of 3

Teach the cat to dance

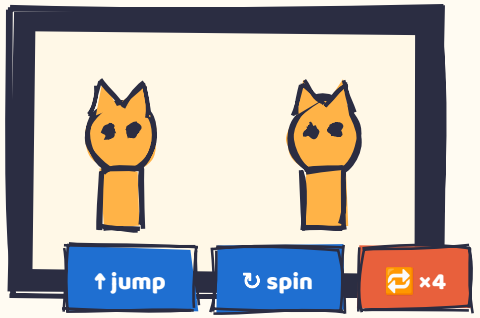
a Open **ScratchJr** and start a new project.

b Drag the **green flag** block to start.

c Add **jump**, **turn** and **move** blocks in a line.

d Tap the green flag. Does the cat dance?

e Change the numbers on the blocks to make moves bigger.



Check: The cat does 3 dance moves.

MAKE

Objective 2 · Build step 2 of 3

Repeat and add music

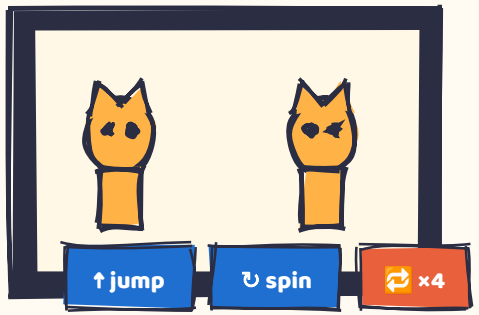
a Drag a **repeat** block around your dance moves.

b Change the number to **4**.

c Tap the microphone: record a beat ('boom, tss, boom, tss').

d Add your sound block at the start of the dance.

e Tap the flag. Is it a party?



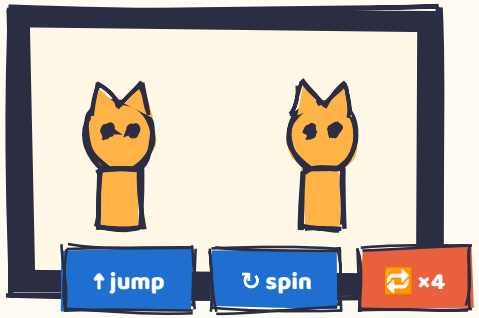
Check: The dance repeats 4 times with your sound.

MAKE

Objective 3 · Build step 3 of 3

Two dancers

- **a** Tap + to add a second character.
- **b** Give it its own green flag and dance moves.
- **c** Make it dance **differently** from the first one.
- **d** Tap the green flag at the top: both dancers start together!
- **e** Paint a disco background!



Check: Both characters dance at the same time.

Test it!

Party test

Repeat number	How long?	Fun or too long?
Repeat 2		
Repeat 4		
Repeat 10		

Talk about it

Which number made the best dance?

Tip

Use the speed block (the running figure) to dance faster!

MAKE

Level up!

Dance challenges

Choose your challenge



Three dancers: add a third dancer.



Costume change: make a dancer change colour mid-dance.



Your song: record a song with your voice.



Message: start the dance when one dancer sends a message.

Think like an engineer

Why do all the dancers start together when we tap the flag?

Boss level

Make a dance that tells a story!

Objective check

Can I really do it? Prove it.

01	Show your character's dance moves.	○ ○ ○
02	Show your repeat block. What number did you choose?	○ ○ ○
03	Tap the flag. Do both dancers start together?	○ ○ ○

Rate yourself

Colour one circle each. Red: not yet. Amber: with help. Green: I can explain it to a friend.

Teacher: Dance show: play every dance on the projector!

Show what you know

What did we learn?

- [x] A dance is moves in order
- [x] Repeat makes moves happen again
- [x] Sound blocks add music
- [x] The green flag starts everyone together

At home
Teach your family your dance with a repeat!



Exit ticket: what does a repeat block do?

Next class:
Rainbow LED Ring!